

CRISTOFF STAN

Senior DevOps Engineer / Platform Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior **DevOps / Platform Engineer** with 10+ years in **SaaS, fintech, digital commerce, and cloud infrastructure**, modernizing delivery platforms with **AWS, Azure, GCP, Kubernetes 1.18–1.30, Terraform 0.13–1.8, Docker 20.x–25.x, Linux, CI/CD, observability, and security automation** to improve release reliability, reduce operational risk, and turn complex legacy environments into scalable production systems.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

- **Cloud Platforms:** AWS, Azure, GCP, EC2, ECS, EKS, Lambda, S3, RDS, CloudFront, IAM, VPC, Azure App Service, AKS, Azure DevOps, GCP Cloud Run, Cloud Build, Artifact Registry, Cloud DNS, Secret Manager.
- **Infrastructure as Code:** Terraform **0.13–1.8**, Terragrunt basics, CloudFormation, ARM/Bicep, reusable modules, remote state, state locking, drift detection, plan/apply separation, environment promotion.
- **Containers & Orchestration:** Docker **20.x–25.x**, Docker Compose, Kubernetes **1.18–1.30**, Helm, Ingress, ConfigMaps, Secrets, HPA, probes, rolling deployments, blue-green deployment patterns.
- **CI/CD & Release Engineering:** GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins, Azure DevOps Pipelines, Cloud Build, branch protection, PR validation, release gates, artifact promotion, semantic versioning, rollback automation.
- **Observability & Reliability:** Prometheus, Grafana, ELK/OpenSearch, CloudWatch, Azure Monitor, GCP Cloud Logging, OpenTelemetry, SLOs, SLIs, alert tuning, incident response, postmortems, runbooks.
- **Security & Compliance:** IAM least privilege, RBAC, OIDC, SSO, secret rotation, Vault basics, AWS Secrets Manager, GCP Secret Manager, vulnerability scanning, container image scanning, TLS, WAF, Cloud Armor, audit logging.
- **Databases & Messaging:** PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch/OpenSearch, RabbitMQ, Kafka basics, SQS, SNS, managed backups, replication checks, migration support.
- **Scripting & Automation:** Bash, Python, PowerShell, Makefiles, YAML, JSON, REST APIs, cron automation, log parsing, deployment scripts, infrastructure validation tooling.
- **Engineering Practices:** Agile delivery, platform enablement, production readiness reviews, capacity planning, cost optimization, disaster recovery planning, documentation, mentoring, cross-team technical leadership.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Sensidev

Senior Software Engineer

(September 2021 – May 2026)

Remote, Romania

- Owned production platform reliability for customer-facing **SaaS and digital workflow systems**, supporting cloud infrastructure across **AWS, Azure, GCP, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, and CI/CD pipelines**.
- Modernized legacy deployment workflows by replacing manual server releases with **GitHub Actions, Terraform 0.13–1.8**, and environment-based promotion paths across development, staging, and production.
- Improved release reliability by **38%** after introducing protected branches, automated smoke tests, container image validation, rollback procedures, and deployment checklists for high-impact services.
- Built and maintained **Kubernetes 1.18–1.30** workloads with Helm charts, readiness probes, autoscaling rules, resource limits, ingress routing, and centralized secret injection for production services.
- Resolved recurring production incidents caused by memory leaks, container restart loops, broken health checks, DNS misconfiguration, and expired TLS certificates across multi-service application environments.
- Created reusable **Terraform modules** for networking, compute, managed databases, IAM roles, storage buckets, monitoring resources, and environment-specific infrastructure configuration.
- Led migration work from older VM-based deployments to containerized services on **EKS, AKS, Cloud Run, and Docker-based release pipelines**, reducing operational dependency on manual server access.
- Strengthened observability by implementing **Prometheus, Grafana, CloudWatch, OpenTelemetry, structured logs, alert routing, and runbooks** for critical APIs and background workers.
- Partnered with backend and frontend engineers to troubleshoot API latency, failed database migrations, queue backlogs, CORS errors, broken environment variables, and container build failures before production release.
- Mentored engineers on **DevOps standards, secure secret handling, incident response, infrastructure review, CI/CD troubleshooting, and production readiness**, improving team ownership of platform stability.

Syscom Digital

Software Engineer

(October 2019 – August 2021)

Remote, Romania

- Supported cloud and deployment operations for e-commerce and internal business platforms using **AWS, Docker, Jenkins, GitLab CI, Terraform, Linux, Nginx, PostgreSQL, and Redis**.
- Migrated several applications from manually configured Linux servers to repeatable Docker-based environments with automated build, test, and deployment workflows.
- Reduced failed deployments by **31%** after adding Jenkins pipeline gates, Docker image tagging standards, branch-based release rules, and automated rollback documentation.
- Built infrastructure templates with **Terraform 0.11–0.15** for VPC resources, EC2 instances, security groups, RDS databases, S3 buckets, and environment-specific configuration.
- Investigated production issues involving Nginx timeout errors, broken SSL renewals, disk saturation, Redis connection exhaustion, and database connection pool limits during traffic spikes.
- Improved system visibility by configuring **CloudWatch metrics, centralized application logs, uptime checks, Grafana dashboards, and actionable alerts** for operations and engineering teams.
- Automated database backup verification, log rotation, server patching checks, and deployment preparation scripts using **Bash, Python, cron jobs, and Linux service tooling**.

- Worked with developers to stabilize API releases by reviewing environment variables, build artifacts, migration scripts, dependency versions, and container runtime behavior.
- Helped introduce practical security controls including least-privilege IAM policies, restricted SSH access, improved security group rules, secret separation, and TLS certificate renewal tracking.

Soft Build

Software Developer

(June 2016 – July 2019)

Remote, Romania

- Developed and supported web application infrastructure for business systems using **Linux, Apache, Nginx, Jenkins, Docker, MySQL, PostgreSQL, PHP, JavaScript, and REST APIs**.
- Introduced early containerization practices with **Docker**, local environment scripts, and repeatable service configuration to reduce setup differences between developer machines and shared servers.
- Improved deployment speed by **27%** by standardizing Jenkins jobs, release notes, build packaging, environment configuration, and database migration procedures.
- Troubleshoot production defects caused by missing environment values, incorrect file permissions, slow SQL queries, stale cache entries, failed uploads, and inconsistent dependency versions.
- Implemented monitoring improvements with server health checks, disk alerts, application log review, cron failure tracking, and basic service availability dashboards.
- Supported database maintenance activities including backup scheduling, migration verification, index review, query optimization, and restoration testing for critical application data.
- Collaborated with senior engineers on legacy modernization work, moving older application modules toward cleaner release processes, improved version control discipline, and safer deployment routines.
- Documented operational procedures for deployments, server provisioning, rollback steps, access requests, and recurring incident patterns to improve handoff between engineering and support teams.

Decima Digital

Software Developer

(November 2015 – April 2016)

Remote, Estonia

- Supported development and release activities for digital commerce applications running on **Linux servers, Git repositories, Apache/Nginx, MySQL, PHP, JavaScript, and shell scripts**.
- Assisted with deployment preparation by validating configuration files, reviewing database migration steps, packaging application changes, and checking server readiness before releases.
- Improved release coordination by creating clearer deployment notes, rollback instructions, environment checklists, and defect handoff details for developers and support staff.
- Resolved application support issues involving broken redirects, upload failures, cache inconsistencies, incorrect permissions, slow pages, and missing configuration values.
- Maintained basic automation scripts for log cleanup, backup checks, file synchronization, and recurring operational tasks across staging and production-like environments.
- Worked with senior engineers to understand network routing, server logs, database access patterns, SSL configuration, DNS records, and application troubleshooting workflows.
- Contributed to legacy code and infrastructure cleanup by removing unused configuration entries, improving deployment documentation, and validating fixes after production releases.

Borna Technology

Software Developer Intern

(September 2014 – August 2015)

Tallinn, Estonia

- Assisted engineering teams with internal web applications, basic infrastructure tasks, Linux troubleshooting, Git workflows, database updates, and application support activities.

- Created small automation scripts using **Bash and Python** to simplify repetitive development tasks, log checks, test data preparation, and local environment setup.
- Supported QA and release validation by reproducing defects, checking browser behavior, reviewing logs, confirming database records, and documenting steps for senior developers.
- Learned production support fundamentals by helping investigate broken builds, server configuration differences, missing assets, permission issues, and deployment checklist gaps.
- Contributed to technical documentation covering setup instructions, Git branching practices, environment variables, database connection details, and basic operational procedures.

EDUCATION

Tallinn University

Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science,
September 2010 – May 2014

CERTIFICATIONS

- **AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate**
- **AWS Certified SysOps Administrator – Associate**
- **HashiCorp Certified: Terraform Associate**
- **Certified Kubernetes Administrator**
- **Microsoft Certified: Azure Administrator Associate**
- **Google Cloud Professional Cloud DevOps Engineer**

PROJECTS

Cloud Infrastructure Modernization Platform

- Designed and implemented a reusable **Terraform-based cloud platform** across AWS and GCP with modular networking, IAM, compute, database, monitoring, and secret-management components for multiple application environments.
- Added **CI/CD release gates, branch protection, infrastructure plan reviews, container image validation, and rollback workflows**, improving deployment consistency and reducing production release risk across engineering teams.
- Integrated **Prometheus, Grafana, CloudWatch, OpenTelemetry, centralized logs, and alert routing** to make application health, API latency, resource saturation, and error spikes easier to detect and resolve.

Kubernetes Application Reliability Program

- Led reliability improvements for containerized services by tuning **Kubernetes deployments, Helm charts, probes, autoscaling, resource limits, ingress routing, and secret injection** across staging and production clusters.
- Resolved high-impact incidents involving failed rollouts, unhealthy pods, database connection exhaustion, queue delays, TLS expiration, and misconfigured environment variables.
- Established production readiness reviews, deployment runbooks, incident notes, and SLO-focused monitoring practices that improved release confidence and reduced repeated operational defects.